



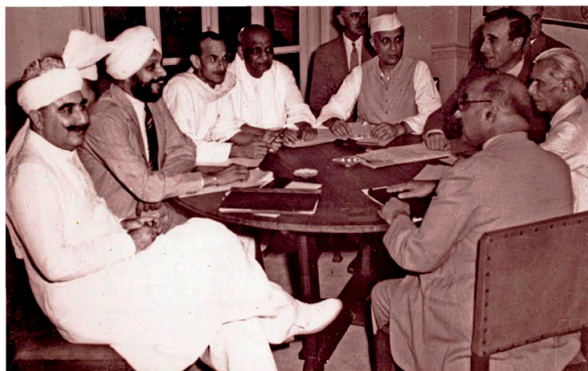
1869-1948 MAHATMA GANDHI

The most charismatic of India's independence leaders, Gandhi was imprisoned many times for his campaigns against colonial rule. An advocate of non-violent resistance, he also agitated throughout his life for social justice.

15 August 1947

INDIA WINS INDEPENDENCE

In June 1947, Britain's Viceroy in India announced the forthcoming end of British rule and the creation of two independent entities, India and Pakistan. Once the Indian Independence Act had duly passed through the British Parliament, the two nations achieved full sovereignty. However, sectarian violence claimed more than a million lives.



Indian leaders accept transfer of power

1946

5 March 1946

Winston Churchill's "Iron Curtain" speech presages the Cold War

16 August 1946 Rioting

breaks out in India following the Muslim League's calls for a separate Pakistani state

June 1946

CIVIL WAR IN CHINA

During World War II, Chinese Nationalist forces under Chiang Kai-shek had struggled for supremacy against Mao Zedong's Communists. After the defeat of Japan, Chiang launched a large-scale assault on Communist positions in the north of China. Despite initial gains, there was no decisive breakthrough in the struggle for dominance.



Chinese Nationalist troops march out of Canton

